CITY OF ARROYO GRANDE
IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE D-26

On June 9, 2026 the City Council unanimously voted to place Measure "D-26" on the November 3, 2026 general municipal election ballot. By placing Measure "D-26" on the ballot, the City complies with California Elections Code section 9217, which requires a majority of voters to approve repealing or amending an ordinance previously adopted by voters.

If approved by a majority of Arroyo Grande voters, this Measure would repeal and replace Measure A (1990) and Measure E-16 (2016), and permit the City of Arroyo Grande to participate in the California State Water Project and purchase State water without prior voter approval and without declaring a local water emergency.

Measure A provides that the City shall not participate in the California State Water Project without majority voter approval. Measure E-16 made a limited exception, which allows for the purchase of State water without majority voter approval during local water emergencies declared by the City Council. Measure D-26 would repeal and replace both of these measures and authorize the City of Arroyo Grande to participate in the California State Water Project and to purchase State water without majority voter approval and without a declared local water emergency. Instead, if Measure D-26 is approved, participation in the California State Water Project could be authorized by a majority vote of a quorum of the City Council.

The California State Water Project is a water storage and delivery system of reservoirs and aqueducts that stores and distributes water throughout California. It is maintained and operated by the California Department of Water Resources.

A "yes" vote on Measure "D-26" will authorize the City to participate in the California State Water Project without majority voter approval or a declared local water emergency.

A "no" vote on Measure "D-26" will mean that the City may only participate in the California State Water Project with majority voter approval or with a Council-declared local water emergency.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure "D-26". If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call the City's elections official at (805) 473-5418 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

s/ ISAAC ROSEN
City Attorney

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE D-26

Vote Yes on Measure D-26 - Participation in State Water Project. The D means DIVERSIFY our water supply.

Right now, Arroyo Grande gets most of its water from Lopez Lake and local groundwater wells. These local sources have worked for us, but they are not reliable. Lake levels go up and down depending on rainfall, and an ongoing federal lawsuit is threatening the stability of the Lopez Lake water supply.

Under old rules from 1990 and 2016, the city can only buy extra water from the State Water Project during a big emergency or after holding another citywide vote. But these bureaucratic rules make it hard for the city to plan ahead and ensure sufficient water supplies when our local supplies are threatened.

Measure D-26 would let us respond proactively. It enables the City Council to buy water from the State Water Project when it is best for Arroyo Grande. This would give the city more flexibility to get water from different sources and better prepare for dry years.

This measure does not force the city to buy state water. It simply gives choice. Even better, no new pipes or big construction projects would be needed. More reliable water supplies without massive new investments means more options in times of need.

Measure D-26 protects our property values by helping to secure reliable water supplies. Imagine the impact of owning property that has no water supply or it is greatly restricted.

In a time when droughts and legal fights over local water are threatening this basic life necessity, we must throw off old restrictions and work proactively. Measure D-26 would help give Arroyo Grande more choices and better protection for the future.

Vote Yes on Measure D-26 to diversify our water supply and secure this precious resource for future generations.

s/ Caren Ray Russom
Mayor, City of Arroyo Grande
Principal Officer, on behalf of the Arroyo Grande City Council